CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Communicate Like a CEO Course Handbook

"Speak with the clarity, calm and authority of the top 1%."



Executive Leadership & Communication Track | 6 Weeks | All Levels 28-Page Illustrated Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

Course Foreword



Most people believe great communicators are born that way. They are not. The calm executive who answers a tough question in one clean sentence spent years building that skill on purpose. You can build it faster, because you now have a map.

This book is short on theory and long on practice. Every chapter ends with something to do out loud, on camera, or in front of a person. Reading it will teach you nothing. Doing the drills will change how people treat you.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

By the last page you will structure your thoughts under pressure, hold a room, and say hard things without losing respect, whether you are pitching an investor or answering a question in class.

A warning: you will feel awkward the first few times. That awkwardness is the sound of a skill being installed. Push through it and, within weeks, people start describing you with a word you may never have heard about yourself before, 'impressive'.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this expanded 28-page illustrated handbook unpacks every module in spacious detail with visual diagrams, real East African case studies, and step-by-step labs. Reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Learning Outcomes

01

Executive presence starts in your head: Presence is self-control made visible.

02

Body language and the power of the pause: First impressions are physical, not verbal.

03

Persuade without pressure: Start from their goal, not your ask.

04

Own the camera and the online room: Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, each of the 8 modules is given a dedicated two-page spread: first unpacking the concept visually, then walking through a real field scenario and hands-on lab.

By Module 08, you will have built and verified a complete executive message ready to serve employers, clients, ministries, and communities with excellence.

Table of Contents

Course Foreword & Key Outcomes 02

01 Foundations & Core Mindset (Modules 1 to 2) 05

02 Core Frameworks & Strategy (Modules 3 to 4) 10

03 Execution & Applied Mastery (Modules 5 to 6) 15

04 Scaling & Capstone Project (Modules 7 to 8) 20

05 Complete Syllabus & Fellowship Reflections 25

06 90-Day Action Plan & Stewardship 27



01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 01: Executive presence starts in your head | Module 02: Say less, mean more

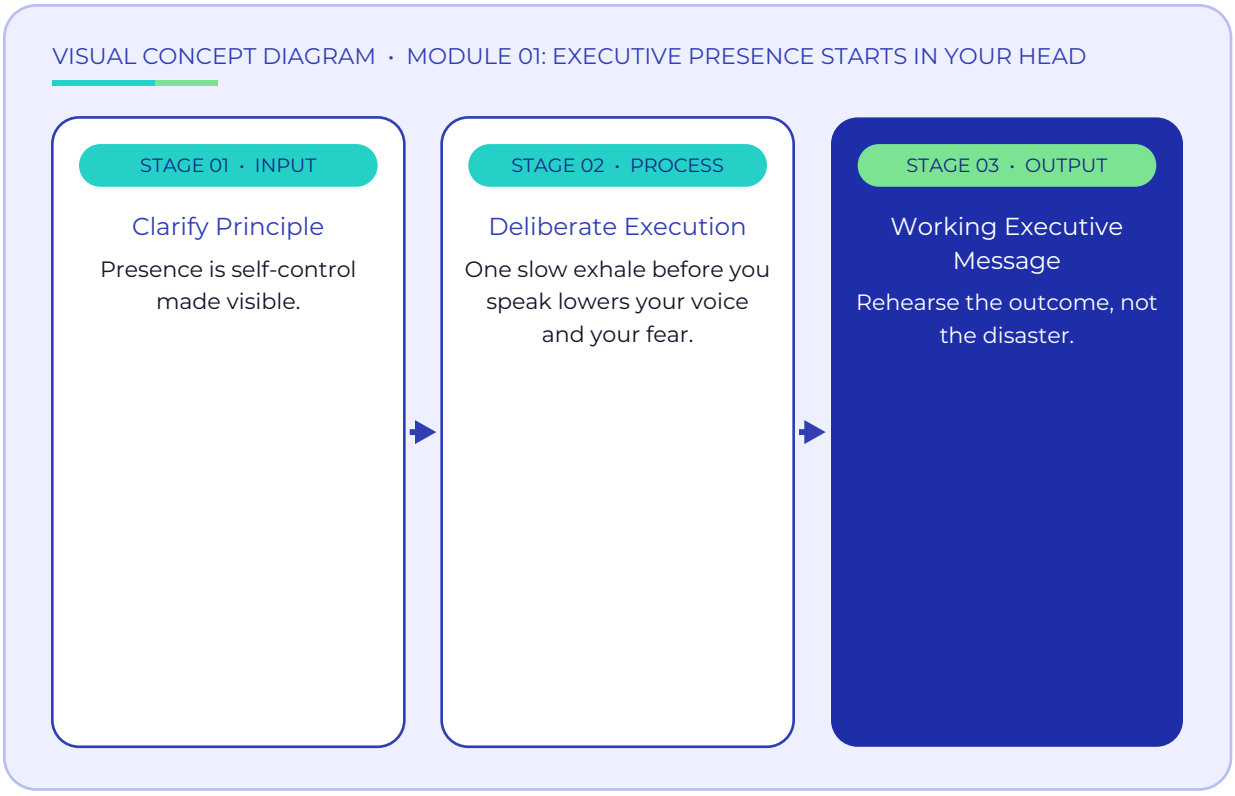
MODULE 01 · PART 1

1.1 Executive presence starts in your head

Presence is not volume or expensive clothes. It is the visible signal that you are in control of yourself. Before you fix your words, you fix the story you tell yourself in the ten seconds before you speak. Nervous people rehearse the disaster: 'What if I forget, what if they laugh.' Leaders rehearse the outcome: 'I know this. I am here to help them understand it.'

Your body follows your mind, but the reverse is also true. Stand with both feet planted, shoulders down, breathe out slowly before your first word. That single slow exhale drops your voice half a tone and tells your nervous system there is no lion in the room. Do it every time until it is automatic.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *executive presence starts in your head* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that presence is self-control made visible., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 01 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Before a big pitch, a founder I mentored used to shake. We changed one thing: three slow breaths and the sentence 'I am the most prepared person in this room.' Same slides, same voice, but investors started leaning in. Nothing changed except what she believed as she walked in.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 01

Your Practical Task: Record a 60-second phone video introducing yourself and what you do. Watch it once. Note one thing your body does when nervous (touching your face, looking down, rushing). Record it again, fixing only that one thing.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 01 Key Takeaways

01

Presence is self-control made visible.

02

One slow exhale before you speak lowers your voice and your fear.

03

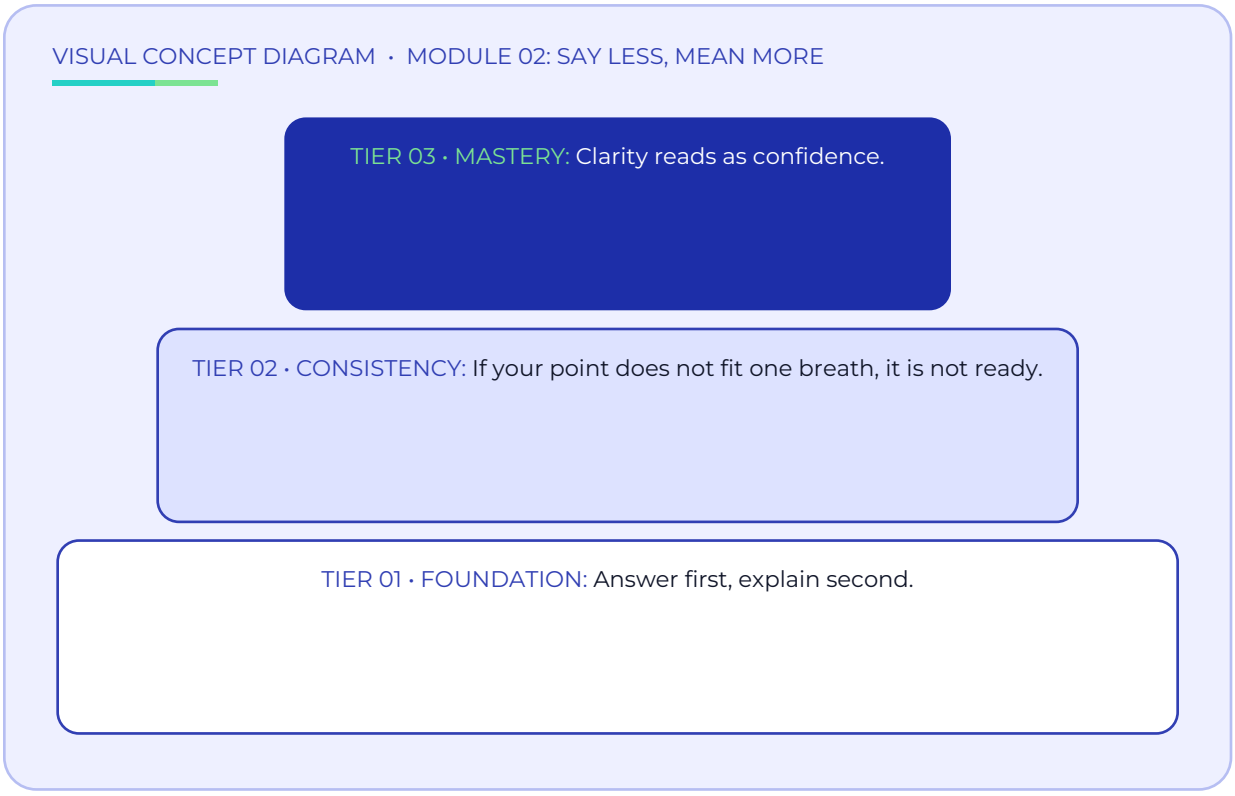
Rehearse the outcome, not the disaster.

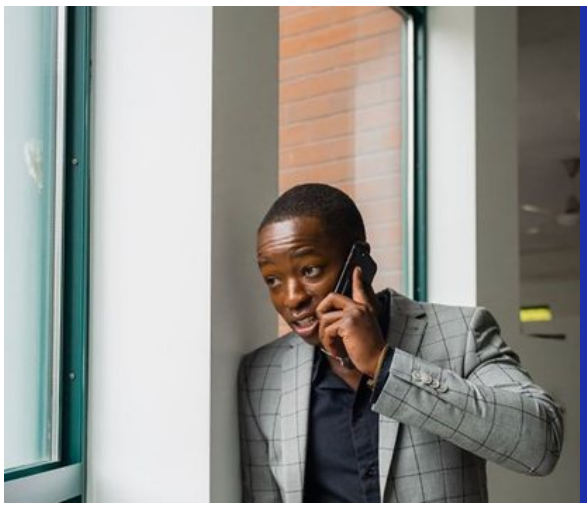
1.2 Say less, mean more

The fastest way to sound senior is to cut words. Juniors explain everything; leaders lead with the conclusion, then support it. This is called answering first. If your boss asks 'Will we finish by Friday?' do not narrate the whole week. Say: 'Yes, two tasks remain and both are on track.' Headline first, detail on request.

Practise the one-breath rule: your main point should fit in a single breath. If you run out of air before your point lands, it is too long. Write your key message as one sentence before any important conversation. If you cannot, you are not ready to speak yet, you are still thinking out loud.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *say less, mean more* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that answer first, explain second., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 02 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Two people ask for a raise. The first talks for four minutes about effort and loyalty. The second says: 'I have taken on the reports work that used to need two people. I would like my pay to reflect that.' One breath, one clear ask. Guess who gets taken seriously.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 02

Your Practical Task: Take something you explained recently in a long message. Rewrite it as one sentence that leads with the conclusion. Send that version next time.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 02 Key Takeaways

01

Answer first, explain second.

02

If your point does not fit one breath, it is not ready.

03

Clarity reads as confidence.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 03: Body language and the power of the pause | Module 04: Structure any talk in three moves

MODULE 03 · PART 1

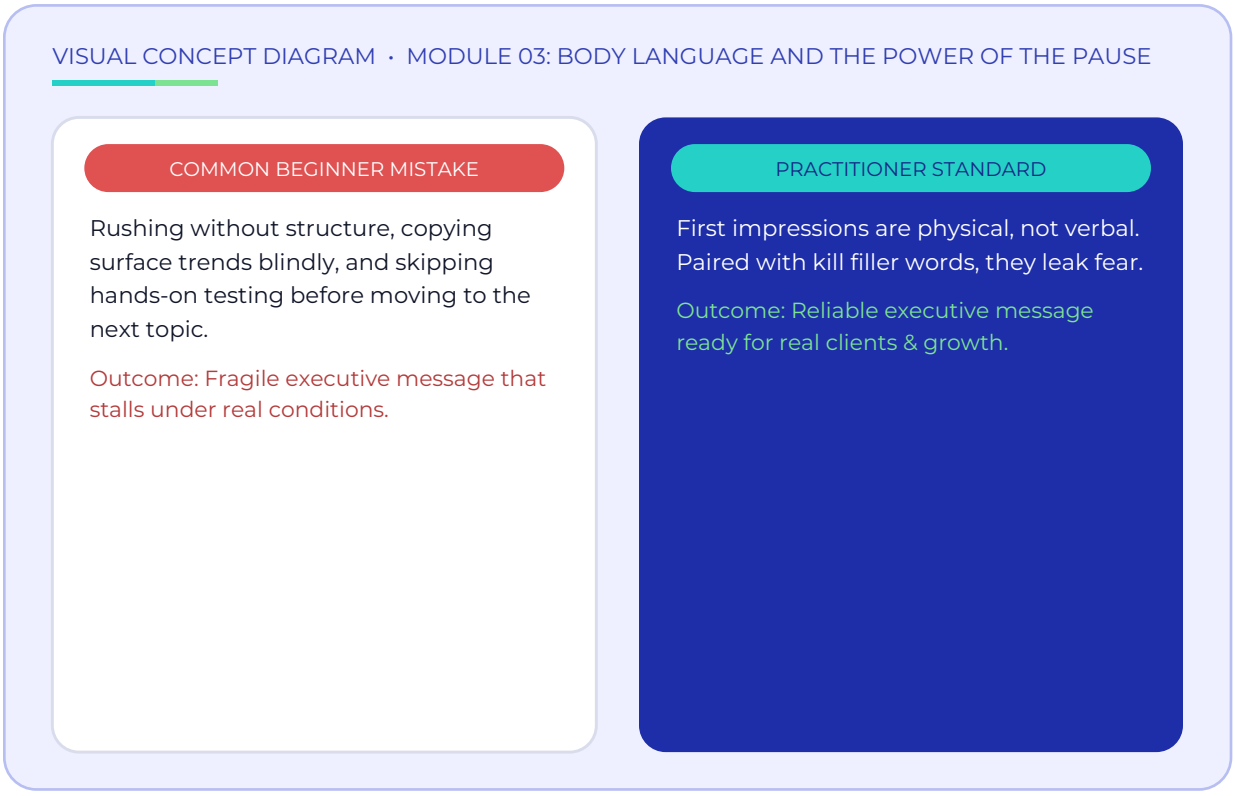
2.1 Body language and the power of the pause

People decide how to feel about you before they process your words. Eye contact says 'I am not afraid of you.' An open chest and steady hands say 'I belong here.' You do not need to perform power poses; you need to stop the small habits that leak fear, fidgeting, filler words, and the nervous laugh at the end of your own sentences.

Your most powerful tool is silence. When you finish a point, stop. Do not fill the gap with 'so, yeah, that is basically it.' A confident pause forces attention and signals that you meant what you said. Amateurs fear silence; professionals use it as punctuation.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *body language and the power of the pause* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that first impressions are physical, not verbal., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 03: BODY LANGUAGE AND THE POWER OF THE PAUSE





MODULE 03 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
In interviews, the strongest candidates answer, then go quiet. The weak ones keep talking to fill the pause and undo their good answer. The pause is not empty, it is you holding the frame.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 03

Your Practical Task: In your next three conversations, when you finish a sentence, count 'one-two' silently before adding anything. Notice how people lean in to fill the space instead of you.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 03 Key Takeaways

01

First impressions are physical, not verbal.

02

Kill filler words, they leak fear.

03

Silence after a point is strength, not a mistake.

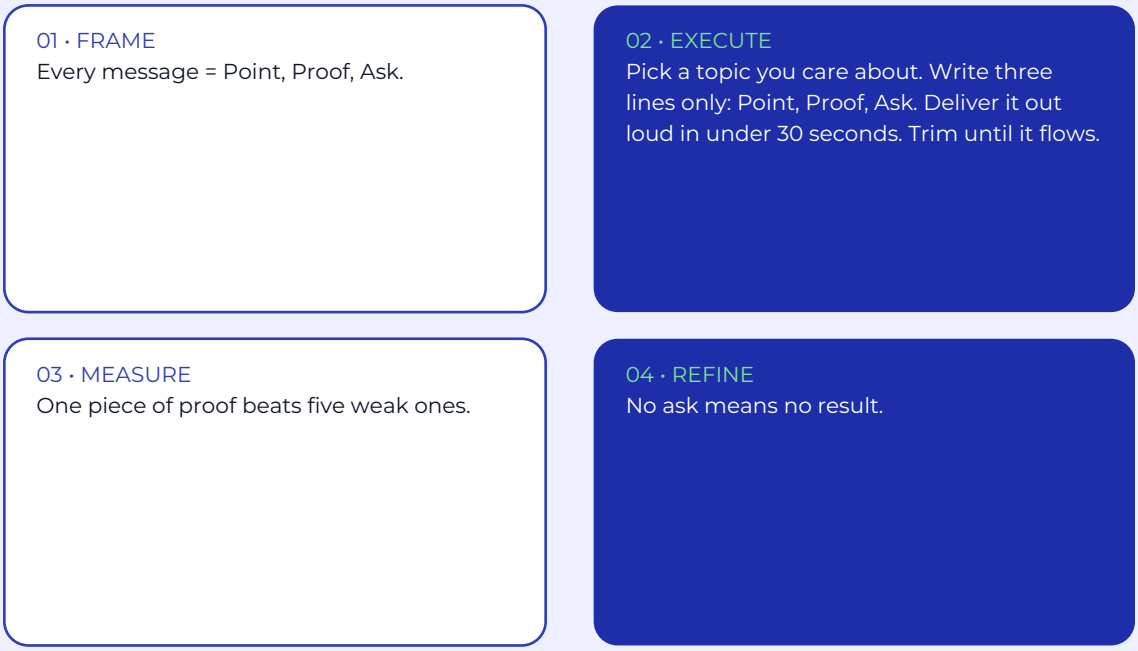
2.2 Structure any talk in three moves

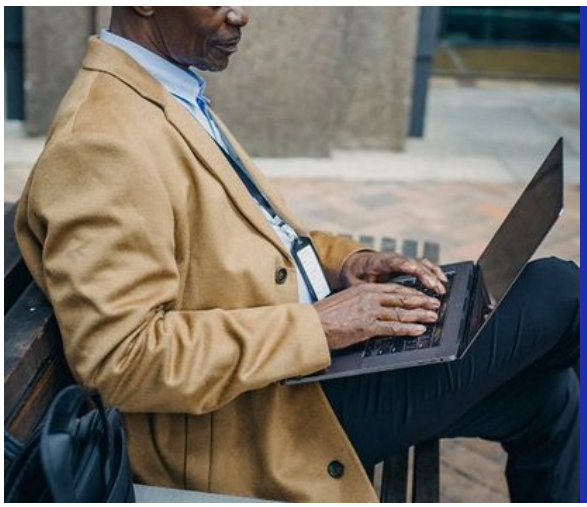
Whether you have thirty seconds or thirty minutes, a strong message has the same skeleton: the point, the proof, the ask. Point, what you want them to know. Proof, one story, number, or example that makes it real. Ask, what you want them to do next. Most people give proof with no point and no ask, so nothing happens.

This structure works for a WhatsApp voice note, a class presentation, or a funding pitch. It removes rambling because you always know which of the three moves you are in. When you feel lost mid-sentence, ask yourself: point, proof, or ask?, and jump to the next one.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *structure any talk in three moves* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that every message = point, proof, ask., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 04: STRUCTURE ANY TALK IN THREE MOVES





MODULE 04 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Pitch in three moves: 'We help boda riders in Jinja earn more (point). In our pilot, ten riders raised their weekly income by a third (proof). I am asking for equipment to reach a hundred more (ask).' Twelve seconds. Fundable.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 04

Your Practical Task: Pick a topic you care about. Write three lines only: Point, Proof, Ask. Deliver it out loud in under 30 seconds. Trim until it flows.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 04 Key Takeaways

01

Every message = Point, Proof, Ask.

02

One piece of proof beats five weak ones.

03

No ask means no result.



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 05: Persuade without pressure | Module 06: Handle hard conversations and feedback

MODULE 05 · PART 1

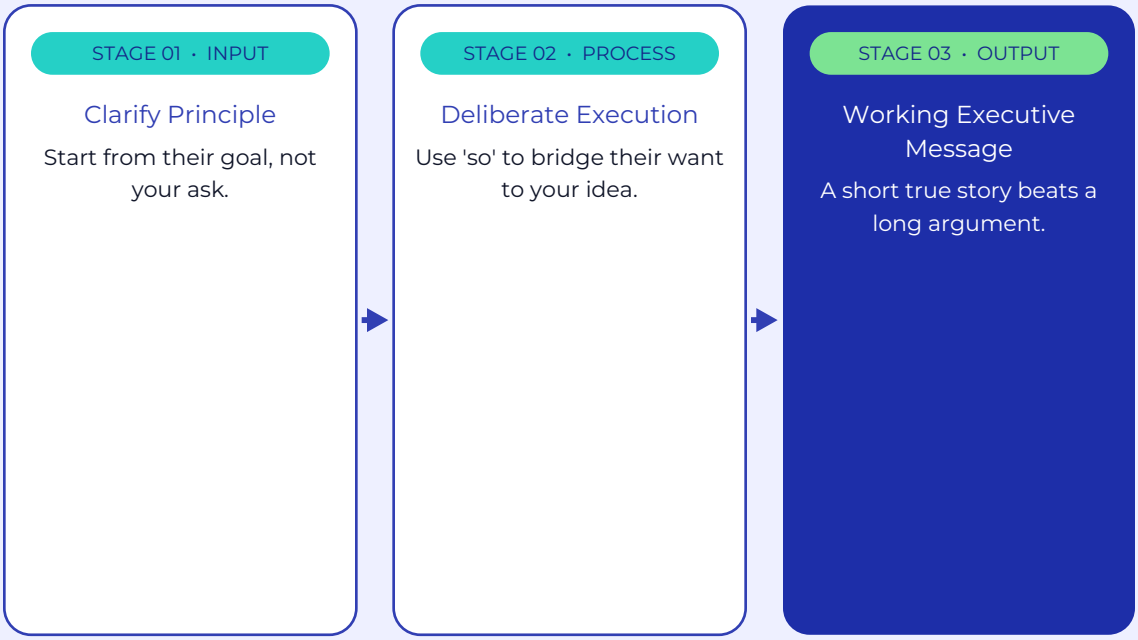
3.1 Persuade without pressure

Persuasion is not tricking people; it is helping them see why your idea serves what they already want. Start from their world, not yours. Before you propose anything, name their goal or fear out loud: 'You want this delivered without surprises, right?' When people feel understood, their resistance drops and they can actually hear you.

Then bridge from their goal to your idea using the word 'so': 'You want it done right the first time, so I suggest we test with five users before we launch.' Facts inform, but stories move. Wrap your key point in a 20-second real example and it will be remembered long after the meeting ends.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *persuade without pressure* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that start from their goal, not your ask., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 05: PERSUADE WITHOUT PRESSURE





MODULE 05 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A teacher wanted tablets for her class. She did not lead with the cost. She said: 'You care about pass rates. Here is a girl who could not read last term; with practice on one shared tablet, she now can.' The story sold the tablets.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 05

Your Practical Task: Think of something you want someone to agree to. Write the first sentence starting with THEIR goal, not yours. Practise saying it before you make the request.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 05 Key Takeaways

01

Start from their goal, not your ask.

02

Use 'so' to bridge their want to your idea.

03

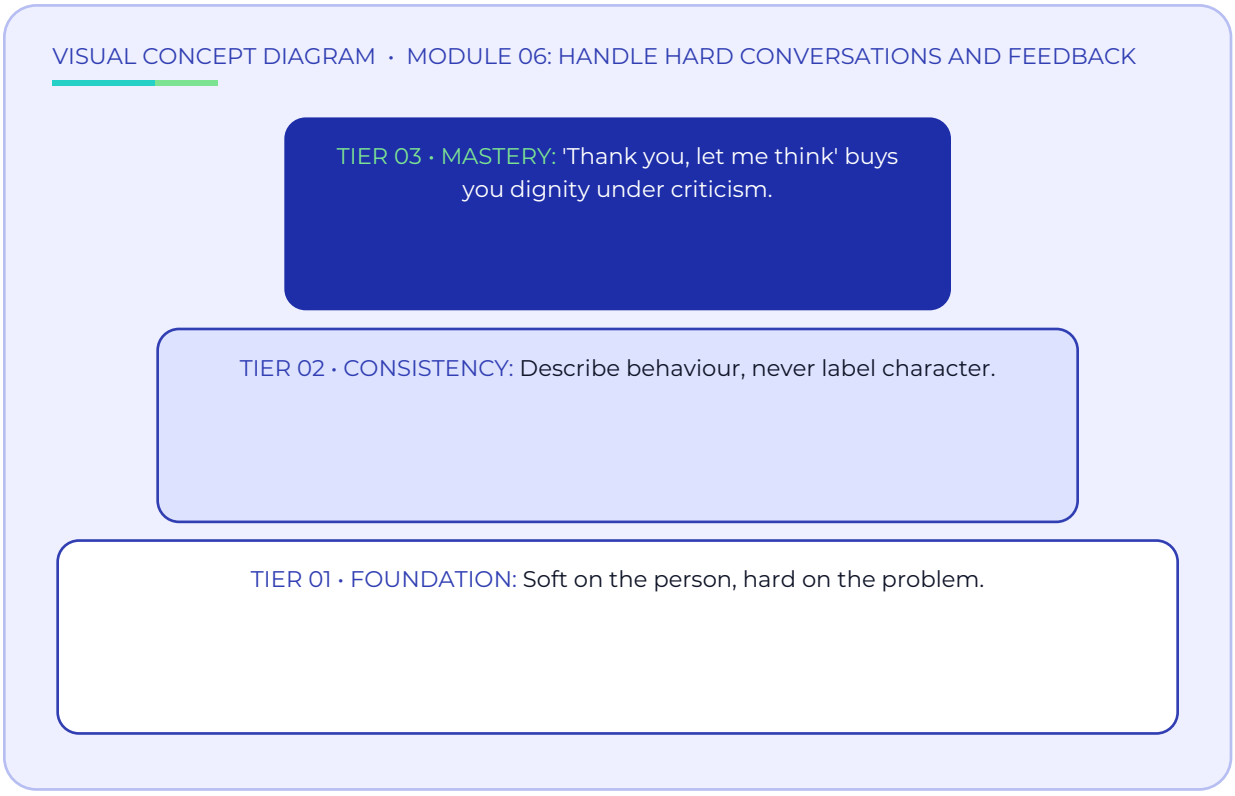
A short true story beats a long argument.

3.2 Handle hard conversations and feedback

Leaders are trusted because they can say uncomfortable things cleanly. The formula is simple: be soft on the person, hard on the problem. Describe the behaviour, not the character. 'The report was late twice this week' is workable. 'You are lazy' starts a war. Facts first, feelings owned by you, then a clear request.

When you receive criticism, do not defend instantly. Breathe, say 'thank you, let me think about that,' and separate the useful 10% from the delivery. The ability to take feedback without collapsing or attacking is one of the rarest and most valuable executive skills there is.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *handle hard conversations and feedback* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that soft on the person, hard on the problem., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 06 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
Instead of 'you never listen', try: 'When I was interrupted in the meeting, I felt my point was lost. Next time, can I finish before we respond?' Same message, but one keeps the relationship and gets the result.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 06

Your Practical Task: Write one difficult thing you need to say to someone. Rewrite it in three parts: the fact, how it affected you, and one clear request. Say it within the week.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 06 Key Takeaways

01

Soft on the person, hard on the problem.

02

Describe behaviour, never label character.

03

'Thank you, let me think' buys you dignity under criticism.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 07: Own the camera and the online room | Module 08: Your CEO-level talk

MODULE 07 · PART 1

4.1 Own the camera and the online room

Most opportunities now begin on a screen, a video call, a voice note, a recorded pitch. The rules shift slightly online. Look at the camera lens, not the faces, so you appear to make eye contact. Sit with light in front of you, not behind. Get close enough that your face fills a good part of the frame; distance reads as disengagement.

On calls, speak a touch slower and pause a beat longer, because there is lag and there are distractions. Start with your point immediately, online attention is short. And when you are not speaking, stay visibly present: nodding and looking engaged is part of communicating, even in silence.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *own the camera and the online room* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that look at the lens to make eye contact., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 07: OWN THE CAMERA AND THE ONLINE ROOM





MODULE 07 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A freelancer doubled his client wins by fixing three things on calls: a window in front of him for light, the camera at eye level on a stack of books, and opening every call with 'Here is what I understood you need, did I get it right?'

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 07

Your Practical Task: Record a 45-second video pitch as if applying for a client or job. Check: eye-level camera, light on your face, point in the first five seconds. Redo until it feels natural.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 07 Key Takeaways

01

Look at the lens to make eye contact.

02

Light in front, camera at eye level.

03

Lead with your point in the first five seconds online.

4.2 Your CEO-level talk

Everything in this book comes together in one deliverable: a three-minute talk that could open a door for you. Choose a real goal, introduce your project, pitch a service, or make a case for change in your community. Build it on Point, Proof, Ask. Rehearse it out loud at least ten times, not in your head.

Rehearsal is where amateurs and professionals split. Record each run, watch it, fix one thing, run again. By the tenth pass you will stop thinking about words and start thinking about the person in front of you, which is the whole point. Then deliver it for real to someone who matters.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *your ceo-level talk* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real executive message. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 08 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
One learner rehearsed her hub pitch eleven times on her phone. On the twelfth, live, she barely looked nervous. The listener's first words were, 'You have clearly done this before.' She hadn't. She had just practised properly.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Communicate Like a CEO workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 08

Your Practical Task: Write and rehearse a 3-minute talk with a real audience in mind. Record ten takes, improving one thing each time. Deliver take eleven to a real person and ask for one piece of feedback.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 08 Key Takeaways

01

Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.

02

Ten imperfect reps beat one perfect plan.

03

A prepared three minutes can change your life.

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice & Competency Matrix

Review every module in Communicate Like a CEO using the table below. Check off each module only after you have completed its hands-on assignment and verified your work against the core principle.

Module	Focus Topic	Core Principle	Workbook Check
Module 01	Executive presence starts in your head	Presence is self-control made visible.	Completed [ ]
Module 02	Say less, mean more	Answer first, explain second.	Completed [ ]
Module 03	Body language and the power of the pause	First impressions are physical, not verbal.	Completed [ ]
Module 04	Structure any talk in three moves	Every message = Point, Proof, Ask.	Completed [ ]
Module 05	Persuade without pressure	Start from their goal, not your ask.	Completed [ ]
Module 06	Handle hard conversations and feedback	Soft on the person, hard on the problem.	Completed [ ]
Module 07	Own the camera and the online room	Look at the lens to make eye contact.	Completed [ ]
Module 08	Your CEO-level talk	Rehearse out loud and on camera, not in your head.	Completed [ ]

CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO STANDARD

Before graduating from this handbook, combine all eight modules into one finished, shareable executive message: *Write and rehearse a 3-minute talk with a real audience in mind. Record ten takes, improving one thing each time. Deliver take eleven to a real person and ask for one piece of feedback.* When ready for mentor feedback, email your work to chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Case Reflections

Real transformation happens when learners turn theory into consistent service. Reflect on these cohort case highlights from across East Africa as you prepare your own project:

"Before a big pitch, a founder I mentored used to shake. We changed one thing: three slow breaths and the sentence 'I am the most prepared person in this room.' Same slides, same voice, but investors started leaning in. Nothing changed except what she believed as she walked in."

Cohort Case Reflection | Starting Strong in Module 01





"Pitch in three moves: 'We help boda riders in Jinja earn more (point). In our pilot, ten riders raised their weekly income by a third (proof). I am asking for equipment to reach a hundred more (ask).' Twelve seconds. Fundable."

Mid-Course Breakthrough | Applying Strategy in Module 04

"One learner rehearsed her hub pitch eleven times on her phone. On the twelfth, live, she barely looked nervous. The listener's first words were, 'You have clearly done this before.' She hadn't. She had just practised properly."

Capstone Completion | Shipping Real Work in Module 08



Stewardship Principle: "Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with excellence, integrity, and faithfulness so your skill becomes a blessing to many."

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Communicate Like a CEO is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 labs and document your baseline specimen in Communicate Like a CEO.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Write and rehearse a 3-minute talk with a real audience in mind. Record ten takes, improving one thing each time. Deliver take eleven to a real person and ask for one piece of feedback.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO Digital Academy
Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Official Gmail Contacts
chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
shambetz@gmail.com

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